IELTS SPEAKING PART 2

PART 1: UNDERSTANDING THE CUE CARD

What is IELTS Speaking Part 2?

In Part 2, you will receive a cue card with a topic and several points to cover.

You will have:

1 minute to prepare
1–2 minutes to speak

The examiner may stop you when your time is finished.

Your main goal

Do not try to memorise a complete answer.

Instead:

Understand → Plan → Develop → Speak → Extend

PART 2: HOW TO TAKE PREPARATION

The 1-Minute Preparation Strategy

You do not have enough time to write sentences.

Therefore, write only:

1. KEYWORDS

Write important words, not complete sentences.

2. DETAILS

Think about:

Who? What? When? Where? Why? How?

3. FEELINGS

Think:

How did I feel? Why?

4. EXAMPLES

Think of one specific example or incident.

5. IMPACT

Think:

What did I learn? How did it affect me?

The 5-Point Preparation Formula

D + B + P + R + I

D = Description
What/who is it?

B = Background
When, where and how did it happen?

P = Personal Connection
What is your connection with it?

R = Reason
Why do you like, remember or recommend it?

I = Impact
Why is it significant?

Optional:

F = Future Connection

Would you like to experience it again or continue with it?

PART 3: WHAT TO WRITE IN YOUR 1-MINUTE NOTES

Imagine the topic is:

Describe a place you visited that you remember well.

Your notes could look like this:

Place: Cox's Bazar
When: last winter
Who: family
What: beach, sunset, seafood
Feeling: relaxed, amazed
Special: first family trip after a long time
Impact: helped me appreciate nature
Future: visit again

Notice:

Do not write:

> **Last winter I went to Cox's Bazar with my family and we had a wonderful time...**

Instead, write:

> **Cox's Bazar → winter → family → sunset → seafood → relaxing → memorable → nature → visit again**

PART 4: HOW TO DEVELOP A CUE CARD ANSWER

STEP 1 — INTRODUCE

Tell the examiner what you are going to talk about.

Useful expressions:

- **To kick off, I'd like to talk about...**
- **At the very outset, I'd say...**
- **One of the most memorable... I've ever...**
- **One person/place/event that immediately comes to mind is...**

- **If I had to choose one, I would say...**

STEP 2 — GIVE BACKGROUND

Answer:

When? Where? Who? How?

Useful expressions:

- **To begin with...**
- **First of all...**
- **It happened when...**
- **I first came across it...**
- **I remember this particularly well because...**

STEP 3 — DEVELOP YOUR ANSWER

Do not simply list information.

Explain + Example + Detail

For example:

> **It was a particularly memorable experience because I had never travelled there with my family before. We spent the entire afternoon exploring the area, and what stood out most was the breathtaking sunset.**

STEP 4 — PERSONALISE

Talk about your feelings and personal connection.

Useful expressions:

- **What I liked most was...**
- **What impressed me most was...**
- **I was particularly fascinated by...**
- **What made it special for me was...**
- **I found it incredibly memorable because...**

STEP 5 — EXPLAIN SIGNIFICANCE

Answer:

Why does it matter?

Useful expressions:

- **As a result...**
- **This experience taught me that...**
- **It had a lasting impact on me because...**
- **Looking back, I realise that...**
- **That is why it remains significant to me.**

STEP 6 — CONCLUDE

Finish naturally.

Useful expressions:

- **Overall...**
- **All in all...**
- **In conclusion...**
- **In summary...**
- **That's why it remains one of the most memorable experiences of my life.**

PART 5: THE BAND 9 DEVELOPMENT FORMULA

A strong answer should not simply answer the bullet points.

ANSWER → EXPLAIN → EXAMPLE → FEELING → IMPACT

Example

Answer:

> **I'd like to talk about a teacher who had a major influence on me.**

Explain:

> **She taught me English during my secondary school years and always encouraged us to express our own ideas.**

Example:

> **For instance, whenever I made a mistake, she would ask me to try again rather than simply correcting me.**

Feeling:

> **I found her approach incredibly motivating because I gradually became more confident.**

Impact:

> **As a result, she played an important role in shaping my attitude towards learning.**

PART 6: HOW TO SPEAK FOR 2 MINUTES

If your answer is too short, develop it using:

WHAT?

What is it?

↓

WHEN/WHERE?

When or where did it happen?

↓

DETAILS?

What happened?

↓

EXAMPLE?

Can you give a specific example?

↓

FEELING?

How did you feel?

↓

WHY?

Why was it important?

↓

IMPACT?

What did you learn?

↓

FUTURE?

Would you do it again?

PART 7: HIGH-LEVEL BUT NATURAL EXPRESSIONS

Starting

- **To kick off...**
- **At the very outset...**
- **To begin with...**
- **First and foremost...**
- **One thing that immediately comes to mind is...**

Adding

- **In addition to this...**
- **Moreover...**
- **Furthermore...**
- **On top of that...**
- **What's more...**

Giving Examples

- **For instance...**
- **For example...**
- **To give you an example...**

- **A good example would be...**

Explaining Feelings

- **I was absolutely fascinated by...**
- **I found it incredibly rewarding...**
- **I was genuinely impressed by...**
- **It left a lasting impression on me.**
- **I found it particularly meaningful.**

Explaining Importance

- **It had a significant impact on me.**
- **It played an important role in my life.**
- **It taught me a valuable lesson.**
- **It broadened my perspective.**
- **It changed the way I think about...**

Concluding

- **Overall...**
- **All in all...**
- **In summary...**
- **Looking back...**
- **That's why it remains particularly memorable to me.**

TOPIC 1 — PERSON

Cue Card

Describe a person you admire.

You should say:

- **Who this person is**
- **How you know about this person**
- **What this person has achieved**
- **And explain why you admire this person**

1-Minute Preparation

Person: _____

Who: _____

Achievement: _____

Qualities: _____

Example: _____

Why admire: _____

Impact: _____

Band 9 Model Answer

One person who immediately comes to mind is Malala Yousafzai, whom I have admired for several years.

To begin with, she is a Pakistani education activist who became internationally recognised for advocating girls' access to education. What I find particularly remarkable about her is that she continued speaking out despite facing extremely serious challenges at a very young age.

What impresses me most is her courage and determination. For instance, rather than allowing a traumatic experience to silence her, she used her experience as a motivation to campaign more strongly for education. She eventually became the youngest Nobel Peace Prize laureate, which was a remarkable achievement.

Personally, I admire her because she has demonstrated that one individual can raise awareness about an issue affecting millions of people. Her story has also made me appreciate the opportunities I have to receive an education.

Overall, I consider her an inspiring person because of her resilience, courage and commitment to education.

TOPIC 2 — PLACE

Cue Card

Describe a tourist place you have visited.

You should say:

- **Where it is**
- **When you visited it**
- **What you did there**

- **And explain why you remember it**

My Notes

Place: _____

Location: _____

When: _____

Who with: _____

Activities: _____

Best moment: _____

Feeling: _____

Band 9 Model Answer

One of the most memorable places I have ever visited is Cox's Bazar, which is located in the southeastern part of Bangladesh.

I visited it a couple of years ago with some members of my family. We stayed there for a few days and spent most of our time exploring the beach, trying local seafood and simply enjoying the scenery.

What impressed me most was the sheer scale of the beach. I remember standing there at sunset and watching the sky gradually change colour while the waves were breaking along the shore. It was incredibly peaceful, particularly because I had been dealing with a fairly demanding routine before the trip.

What made the experience even more meaningful was spending uninterrupted time with my family. We normally have very busy schedules, so having the opportunity to talk, eat together and explore somewhere new was quite special.

Overall, it was much more than a simple holiday. It gave me a chance to relax, reconnect with my family and appreciate the beauty of nature.

TOPIC 3 — SPECIAL EVENT

Cue Card

Describe a special event you attended.

You should say:

- **What the event was**
- **Where and when it took place**
- **Who attended it**
- **And explain why it was special**

My Notes

Event: _____

Date: _____

Place: _____

People: _____

Activities: _____

Special moment: _____

Feeling: _____

Band 9 Model Answer

One special event that immediately comes to mind is a close family wedding that I attended a few years ago.

The wedding took place at a beautifully decorated venue, and almost all of our relatives and close friends were present. From the beginning, there was a wonderful atmosphere because everyone seemed genuinely excited to be together.

During the ceremony, I remember feeling particularly emotional because it was a major milestone for someone very close to me. After the formal part of the ceremony, we had dinner, listened to music and spent hours talking with relatives whom I rarely get to see.

What made the event especially memorable was the sense of togetherness. It was not simply about the wedding itself; it brought several generations of our family together in one place.

Looking back, I think that was the most meaningful aspect of the occasion. It reminded me of the importance of family relationships and gave me memories that I still cherish.

TOPIC 4 — FESTIVAL OR CELEBRATION

Cue Card

Describe a festival or celebration that is important to you.

You should say:

- **What it is**
- **When it is celebrated**
- **How people celebrate it**
- **And explain why it is important**

My Notes

Festival: _____

When: _____

Traditions: _____

Food: _____

People: _____

Personal connection: _____

Importance: _____

Band 9 Model Answer

One celebration that is particularly meaningful to me is Eid, which is widely celebrated in Bangladesh.

What I particularly enjoy about Eid is that it brings families and communities together. Before the celebration, people usually prepare special food, buy new clothes and make arrangements to visit relatives and friends.

On the day itself, people attend prayers and then spend time with family members. One of my favourite parts is having a meal together because traditional dishes are prepared specially for the occasion.

However, I think the emotional aspect is even more important than the celebrations themselves. People often visit relatives whom they have not seen for a long time, and there is a strong emphasis on generosity and sharing.

For me, Eid represents family, togetherness and gratitude. That is why it is not merely a festival; it is an opportunity to strengthen relationships and create meaningful memories.

TOPIC 5 — BOOK OR MOVIE

Cue Card

Describe a book or movie you enjoyed.

You should say:

- **What it is**
- **When you experienced it**
- **What it is about**
- **And explain why you enjoyed it**

My Notes

Title: _____

Type: _____

When: _____

Main idea: _____

Favourite character: _____

Best part: _____

Lesson: _____

Band 9 Model Answer

A book that left a lasting impression on me is To Kill a Mockingbird by Harper Lee.

I read it some time ago, and what immediately stood out to me was the way the story deals with themes such as justice, prejudice and moral development. The story is narrated from the perspective of a young girl, which makes the serious issues surprisingly accessible.

The character I found most memorable was Atticus Finch because he tries to do what he believes is morally right even when the people around him disagree with him. I found this particularly thought-provoking because it demonstrates how difficult it can be to stand by your principles.

What I enjoyed most was that the book did not simply tell me what to think. Instead, it encouraged me to reflect on fairness, empathy and how people form opinions about others.

Overall, it was a meaningful reading experience because it entertained me while also making me think more deeply about society and human behaviour.

TOPIC 6 — NATURAL PLACE

Cue Card

Describe a natural place you would recommend.

You should say:

- **Where it is**
- **What it looks like**
- **What people can do there**
- **And explain why you recommend it**

My Notes

Place: _____

Location: _____

Appearance: _____

Activities: _____

Best feature: _____

Feeling: _____

Recommendation: _____

Band 9 Model Answer

A natural place I would highly recommend is the Sundarbans, the vast mangrove forest in Bangladesh.

What makes it particularly fascinating is its unique ecosystem and incredible biodiversity. The landscape is very different from an ordinary tourist destination because it consists of waterways, dense forests and a remarkable variety of wildlife.

If someone visited the Sundarbans, I would recommend taking a boat trip because it provides an opportunity to experience the environment from a completely different perspective. The quiet surroundings and natural scenery can be incredibly peaceful.

What I find most impressive is the sense of being surrounded by nature. It makes you realise how important it is to protect natural ecosystems rather than simply viewing them as tourist attractions.

Overall, I would recommend the Sundarbans to anyone interested in nature because it offers both a memorable experience and an opportunity to appreciate the importance of environmental conservation.

TOPIC 7 — GADGET

Cue Card

Describe a useful gadget you own.

You should say:

- **What it is**
- **When you started using it**
- **What you use it for**
- **And explain why it is useful**

My Notes

Gadget: _____

When bought: _____

Main functions: _____

How often: _____

Example: _____

Benefits: _____

Band 9 Model Answer

One gadget that has become an essential part of my daily routine is my smartwatch.

I started using one because I wanted to monitor my daily activity more effectively. At first, I mainly used it to check the time and receive notifications, but gradually I started using many of its other features.

For example, it can track my steps, monitor my workouts and provide information about my sleep. I can also receive messages and reminders without constantly taking out my phone. This is particularly convenient when I am busy or travelling.

What I find most useful is that several functions are combined into one small device. It helps me stay organised while also encouraging me to be more conscious of my physical activity.

Overall, I would say it has made my daily routine more convenient and efficient, which is why I consider it one of the most useful gadgets I own.

TOPIC 8 — USEFUL APP

Cue Card

Describe an app that you find useful.

You should say:

- **What the app is**
- **How often you use it**
- **What you use it for**
- **And explain why it is useful**

My Notes

App: _____

Purpose: _____

Frequency: _____

Features: _____

Example: _____

Benefit: _____

Band 9 Model Answer

An app that I find incredibly useful is Google Maps, which I use whenever I need directions or want to explore an unfamiliar area.

I probably use it several times a week, particularly when I am travelling somewhere I have never been before. Its most useful feature is its ability to provide real-time information about routes and traffic.

For instance, if there is heavy congestion on my usual route, I can quickly check alternative routes. I also use it to locate restaurants, shops and other places nearby, which saves me from having to ask people for directions.

Another feature I appreciate is that I can download maps in advance, which is particularly useful when I have limited internet access.

Overall, the app saves me time, reduces the stress of travelling and makes unfamiliar places much easier to navigate. That is why it has become one of the most useful apps on my phone.

ADDITIONAL HIGH-FREQUENCY CUE CARD TOPICS

Practise these independently.

PEOPLE

1. **Describe a teacher who influenced you.**
2. **Describe a friend you enjoy spending time with.**
3. **Describe a family member you admire.**
4. **Describe a person who gave you useful advice.**
5. **Describe someone you would like to meet.**
6. **Describe a person who is good at their job.**

PLACES

7. **Describe your hometown.**
8. **Describe a place you visit regularly.**
9. **Describe a quiet place you like.**
10. **Describe a crowded place you have visited.**
11. **Describe a place you would like to visit.**
12. **Describe a place where you studied.**

EXPERIENCES

13. **Describe a memorable journey.**
14. **Describe a time when you helped someone.**
15. **Describe a time when someone helped you.**
16. **Describe a time when you learned something new.**
17. **Describe a time when you were proud of yourself.**
18. **Describe a time when you solved a problem.**

OBJECTS

19. **Describe something you bought and liked.**
20. **Describe a gift you received.**
21. **Describe something important you own.**
22. **Describe a piece of technology you use.**
23. **Describe a photograph you like.**
24. **Describe something you lost.**

ACTIVITIES

25. **Describe a hobby you enjoy.**
26. **Describe a sport you like.**
27. **Describe something you do to relax.**
28. **Describe an activity you do with friends.**
29. **Describe something you do at weekends.**
30. **Describe an activity you would like to learn.**

UNIVERSAL CUE CARD PLANNER

Use this page for ANY topic.

Topic:

---

1. WHAT / WHO?

---

2. WHEN?

---

3. WHERE?

---

4. WHO WAS WITH YOU?

---

5. WHAT HAPPENED?

---

6. ONE SPECIFIC EXAMPLE

---

7. HOW DID YOU FEEL?

---

8. WHY WAS IT SPECIAL?

---

9. WHAT DID YOU LEARN?

---

10. FUTURE CONNECTION

THE 60-SECOND PREPARATION CHALLENGE

Set a timer for 60 seconds.

Read the cue card.

Then write only 8–10 keywords.

Cue Card:

Describe a time when you helped someone.

You should say:

- **Who you helped**
- **What you did**

- **Why you helped them**
- **And explain how you felt about it**

Your 60-second notes:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

Now speak for 2 minutes.

HOW TO EXTEND YOUR ANSWER

If you finish too quickly, ask yourself:

WHY?

Why did it happen?

HOW?

How did it happen?

FOR EXAMPLE?

Can I give a specific example?

HOW DID I FEEL?

What was my emotional response?

WHAT DID I LEARN?

What lesson did I take from it?

WHAT HAPPENED AFTERWARDS?

What was the result?

WOULD I DO IT AGAIN?

Why or why not?

These questions help you develop your answer naturally.

AVOID THESE COMMON MISTAKES

1. Giving very short answers

I visited Cox's Bazar. It was nice.

Instead:

✓ Describe the place, explain what you did, give an example and explain why you remember it.

2. Memorising complete answers

Memorisation can make your speech sound unnatural.

Use keywords and ideas, not complete scripts.

3. Using difficult vocabulary unnecessarily

Do not use a word simply because it sounds advanced.

Use vocabulary that you can use accurately and naturally.

4. Listing information

Avoid:

> **It was beautiful. It was interesting. It was exciting. It was amazing.**

Develop your ideas.

> **What impressed me most was the peaceful atmosphere, particularly because I had been dealing with a hectic routine before the trip.**

5. Repeating the same linking words

Do not use:

Moreover... Moreover... Moreover...

Use a natural range of connectors.

6. Ignoring the bullet points

Make sure you address every point on the cue card.

7. Speaking too quickly

Focus on:

Clear pronunciation + natural pace + meaningful pauses

BAND 9 SPEAKING CHECKLIST

After every practice, score yourself honestly.

Fluency & Coherence

☐ **I spoke continuously.**
☐ **I developed my ideas.**
☐ **I used linking expressions naturally.**
☐ **I did not rely heavily on memorised sentences.**

Lexical Resource

☐ **I used a good range of vocabulary.**
☐ **I used topic-specific words.**
☐ **I used collocations naturally.**
☐ **I avoided unnecessary repetition.**

Grammar

☐ **I used both simple and complex sentences.**
☐ **I made few grammatical errors.**
☐ **I used different tenses where appropriate.**

Pronunciation

☐ **My words were clear.**
☐ **My speech was easy to understand.**
☐ **I used natural stress and intonation.**
☐ **I did not speak too quickly.**

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MY PERSONAL ERROR LOG

After every speaking practice, record your mistakes.

MY PERSONAL VOCABULARY BANK

Write useful words and collocations that you can reuse across topics.

People

Places

Experiences

Feelings

Technology

Travel

Education

Daily Life

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FINAL SPEAKING ROUTINE

Before every cue card:

60 SECONDS

10 seconds: Understand the topic

20 seconds: Decide your story/example

20 seconds: Write keywords

10 seconds: Arrange your ideas

Then:

2 MINUTES

Introduction

↓

Background

↓

Details

↓

Example

↓

Personal feeling

↓

Importance/Impact

↓

Conclusion

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FINAL REMINDER

Do not memorise. Develop.

A Band 9-level response is not about using complicated words in every sentence.

Focus on:

Relevant Ideas + Natural Vocabulary + Accurate Grammar + Clear Pronunciation + Strong Development + Fluency

Your formula:

ANSWER → EXPLAIN → EXAMPLE → FEELING → IMPACT

And remember:

> **Plan with keywords. Speak with ideas. Develop with examples.**

Practice. Record. Review. Improve. Repeat.